

Insight Builders

Team 8

Executive Summary

This report examines Costco mission and vision, overall operations, and position among competitors to assess the opportunity to enhance Costco's membership with the integration of electric vehicles (EV) fast chargers on its facilities. The purpose of this paper is to examine if this opportunity aligns with Costco long-term growth and broad cost-leadership model using financial estimations, SWOT evaluations, overall industry information to argue the possible implementation of the strategy and profitability.

Costco emphasizes in providing the best quality products at the lowest price possible for its loyal customers. Costco operations make this possible by maintaining low profit margins on products and relying on profits mostly on their membership fees. Costco's broad cost-leadership is supported by strategies such as limited SKU, bulk purchasing, and fast inventory turnover. However, weaknesses such as geographic revenue concentration and reliance on in-store traffic, create uncertainty on Costco's position in the industry. On the other hand, rising EV ownership and consumer expectation shifting towards online shopping generates new strategic opportunities for Costco.

For our research, we use insights from PESTEL, Porter's Five Forces, and operational data to make a solid solution for Costco. Also, we developed a full financial model which includes NPV, IRR, and cost assumptions related to our strategic recommendation. Our recommendation includes Costco owning its own EV charges network, the use of backward integration to have control over price, integration of renewable energy and expand nationally after validating demand.

Identify the Client's Vision & Mission and Analyze their Strategy

The core vision of Costco Wholesale is to be a trusted, low-cost provider that delivers high-quality goods and services while maintaining strong customer loyalty. Its mission centers on consistently offering members the lowest possible prices without sacrificing product quality, while also maintaining ethical business practices, treating employees well, and delivering value to shareholders.

Rather than simply stating low prices, Costco's strategy reflects a broader commitment to value leadership, balancing affordability with quality. This is evident in their limited product selection, bulk purchasing model, and strong private-label brand, which allows them to control costs while maintaining high standards.

Based on its operations, Costco clearly follows its mission. The company maintains extremely low profit margins on products and instead relies heavily on membership fees for profitability. Additionally, Costco is known for paying higher wages and offering better benefits than many competitors, aligning with its ethical and employee-focused principles. Overall, Costco's actions strongly reflect its stated mission and reinforce customer trust and loyalty.

Costco operates a membership-based warehouse retail model, generating revenue through both product sales and annual membership fees. The company sells a wide range of goods, including groceries, electronics, appliances, clothing, household essentials, and gasoline. In addition to physical products, Costco offers services such as optical care, pharmacies, travel packages, and tire installation. A key element of Costco's strategy is its limited assortment model. Unlike traditional retailers, Costco offers a smaller selection of items but in bulk

quantities. This allows the company to negotiate lower prices from suppliers and pass those savings on to customers. Additionally, the company emphasizes high inventory turnover, meaning products move quickly through stores, reducing storage costs and waste. Costco's private-label brand, Kirkland Signature, plays a major role in its profitability and competitive positioning. By offering high-quality products at lower prices than national brands, Costco strengthens customer loyalty while improving margins. This aligns directly with its value-driven strategy. Another critical component of Costco's operations is its membership model, which serves as a primary profit driver. While product margins are intentionally kept low, membership fees provide a stable and predictable revenue stream. This allows Costco to maintain its low-price reputation while still generating strong overall profits.

Costco generates part of its revenue from merchandise sales, but a significant portion of its net income comes from membership fees. This dual revenue structure is key to its long-term success. Historically, Costco has demonstrated consistent revenue and net income growth, even during periods of economic uncertainty such as the COVID-19 pandemic. During this time, demand for bulk goods increased, further strengthening Costco's position. Over the past decade, Costco has steadily increased both revenue and net income, driven by store expansion, high membership renewal rates, and increased consumer demand for value-based shopping. Its ability to maintain profitability while keeping prices low highlights the strength of its business model. Environmental factors have also played a role in Costco's performance. Inflationary pressures in recent years have made consumers more price sensitive, which benefits Costco's low-cost positioning. At the same time, supply chain disruptions have challenged retailers globally, but Costco's strong supplier relationships and limited product selection have helped it navigate these issues more effectively than many competitors.

SWOT Analysis

Strengths

Inventory Management and Operational Efficiency

One of Costco's most significant internal strengths is its exceptional inventory management, which directly supports its ability to compete on price. Its inventory turnover ratio reached 12.6 in FY2024, clearing stock in an average of just 29 days, compared to 38 days for Amazon, 54 days for Best Buy, and 60 days for Target (GlobalData, 2026). This results from a deliberate strategy: Costco limits its assortment to fewer than 4,000 active SKUs per warehouse, focusing exclusively on fast-moving items (GlobalData, 2026; MarketLine, 2026). By concentrating volume on a narrow selection, Costco reduces carrying costs, minimizes obsolescence risk, and strengthens supplier leverage, passing those savings directly to members as lower prices (GlobalData, 2026).

Membership Model and Customer Loyalty

Costco's membership model generates a predictable revenue stream insulated from the low-margin pressures of merchandise sales. As of September 2024, Costco held 63.7 million Gold Star members and 12.5 million Business members, with renewal rates of 92.9% in the U.S. and Canada and 90.5% globally (MarketLine, 2026). Executive members accounted for approximately 73.3% of worldwide net sales in FY2024, signaling that the tiered membership structure successfully incentivizes deeper spending (MarketLine, 2026). Membership fee revenue grew 5% in FY2024, and fee increases effective September 2024 are projected to

generate an additional \$370 million over the following two years (MarketLine, 2026).

Weaknesses

Geographic Revenue Concentration

Despite operating nearly 900 warehouses across 14 countries, Costco remains heavily dependent on a narrow geographic base. In FY2024, the United States accounted for 72.4% of total revenue, with California alone contributing 27% of U.S. net sales (GlobalData, 2026a; MarketLine, 2026). Canada added another 13.7%, meaning approximately 86% of total revenue originates from just two countries, creating a structural vulnerability to any economic downturn or behavioral shift within the U.S. (MarketLine, 2026). The Other International segment contributed only 13.9% of FY2024 revenue, and Costco has no presence in high-growth markets such as India or Southeast Asia, limiting its ability to offset domestic weakness through international diversification (GlobalData, 2026b; MarketLine, 2026).

Overreliance on In-Store Traffic

Costco's revenue model depends heavily on regular, in-person warehouse visits, and its digital presence has not kept pace with competitors. E-commerce represented only approximately 7% of total net sales in FY2024, with digitally originated sales reaching roughly 9%, while rivals like Amazon and Walmart have invested heavily in logistics and digital infrastructure that capture spending outside the physical retail environment (MarketLine, 2026; GlobalData, 2026c). Growing consumer preference for online shopping has put additional pressure on Costco to modernize its digital capabilities, and this dependence on foot traffic creates fragility if shopping behavior shifts further toward digital channels (GlobalData, 2026d).

Opportunities

Expansion of Electric Vehicle (EV) Service

Costco began exploring opportunities in the EV market but has not fully expanded to keep up with the ongoing demand and maximize revenue. Costco has provided useful information to consumers about EVs through its Costco Auto program, which provides members with information about car prices, understanding charging, overall benefits, and tools to compare different EV options. Costco has also partnered with a variety of dealerships to get membership-exclusive discounts on EV purchases (GlobalData, 2026e). These are important steps, but it is only the beginning for what Costco can achieve in relation to EVs. Installing EV chargers represents a major opportunity due to the rising interest in EVs and people adopting a more environmentally cautious lifestyle. According to Pew Research Center (2023), “Among those who would consider purchasing an EV, about seven-in-ten say helping the environment (72%) and saving money on gas (70%) are major reasons why.” By allocating resources to this idea, Costco will offer more compelling benefits in its membership since no other competitor has implemented it now, which helps to attract new loyal members by offering more convenience and benefits.

E-commerce Growth

Since 2020, people have been more inclined towards online shopping to save time, not worry about lines, and get better prices. In fact, “The rapid evolution of consumer preferences towards online shopping and the convenience of mobile applications has made it easier for

customers to compare prices and services, putting additional pressure on Costco to maintain its competitive edge” (GlobalData, 2026f). Costco has an incredible opportunity to expand into e-commerce and satisfy the needs of customers whose lifestyles are different. Therefore, they need different alternatives to shop. They could implement more convenient ways to obtain your order, such as curbside and store pickup options, and manufacturer coupons, so members get motivated to stay as loyal members. Competitors are already doing many of these things, especially BJ’s, so it is a way to stay on top of competitors and implement ideas that both satisfy the consumer and add value to the membership.

Threats

Industry Competition

According to Porter's five forces framework, the wholesaler industry shows signs of intense competitive rivalry. Costco operates in an extremely competitive environment where competitors are constantly seeking new ways to innovate and add value to their membership. This can be done by investing in technology, digital presence, or finding ways to improve operations and logistics to strength market position. Not only does Costco have to compete with direct competitors, but also with indirect competitors. This is because the threat of substitutes is high, which means consumers have options where they can acquire similar benefits for a reduced cost and without a membership fee. Failure to keep up with these trends in consumer preference and the industry could represent a problem for Costco. This would ultimately affect their profit margins, market share, and reputation.

Economic Volatility

Economic volatility is already happening in today's economy, and it is increasing buyer's bargaining power. Consumers are more price-sensitive, which means they are focusing more on the price than the value of the items. This is due to inflation and uncertain conditions that the market is facing. This represents a pressure for Costco for multiple factors. Considering they are already operating in a low margin structure, as inflation continues to rise, it becomes more difficult to maintain lower margins and push for even lower prices. Additionally, these challenges become a threat to retaining loyal consumers, which is one of Costco's main focuses. Since people are more price-driven if they get better deals and better prices somewhere else, they will easily switch to a competitor.

Companies in the Strongest/Weakest Positions

Within the warehouse club industry, firms compete primarily on price, efficiency, and their ability to retain members. Because the industry operates on low margins and high sales volume, companies that can control costs while maintaining strong customer loyalty tend to outperform competitors. The market is dominated by a small number of firms, with Costco Wholesale, Sam's Club, and BJ's Wholesale Club representing the primary competitors. While these firms operate under similar membership-based models, their performance differs based on how effectively they execute their strategies.

Costco holds the strongest position in the industry because it can consistently execute a broad cost leadership strategy. The company focuses on offering a limited selection of high-quality products at low prices, which allows it to generate high sales volume and maintain efficient operations (Costco Wholesale Corporation, 2025). By keeping its product assortment much smaller than traditional retailers, Costco can negotiate better pricing with suppliers and reduce overall costs. This approach leads to faster inventory turnover and reinforces its ability to

offer lower prices than competitors. In addition, Costco's membership model provides a stable and predictable source of revenue while also creating strong customer loyalty, with renewal rates exceeding 90% (Costco Wholesale Corporation, 2025). These factors allow Costco to maintain consistent traffic and outperform competitors in both efficiency and retention.

Sam's Club operates with a similar cost leadership strategy, but its execution is not as strong as Costco's. As a subsidiary of Walmart, Sam's Club benefits from a significant scale and purchasing power, which allows it to offer competitive pricing and a wide range of products. However, this broader product assortment reduces some of the efficiency advantages seen in Costco's model. Research comparing the two firms highlights that both retailers provide bulk purchasing and value pricing, but differ in product selection, store experience, and membership benefits, which ultimately influences consumer preference. In addition, Sam's Club has lower membership renewal rates than Costco, suggesting weaker customer loyalty. While the company remains a strong competitor, it has not been able to fully match Costco's ability to combine operational efficiency with high customer retention.

BJ's Wholesale Club is in a weaker position compared to both Costco and Sam's Club because it lacks the same level of scale and efficiency. Although BJ's also operates under a membership-based model, it offers a wider product assortment, which reduces its ability to achieve the same cost advantages as its competitors. Carrying more SKUs limits inventory efficiency and weakens supplier bargaining power, making it more difficult to compete on price. In addition, BJ's has a more limited geographic presence, which restricts its growth potential and overall market reach. These factors place BJ's at a competitive disadvantage, particularly in an industry where scale and efficiency are critical to success.

These differences can be further understood through a strategic group map, which compares firms based on product assortment and membership renewal rates. Costco is positioned with low product variety and high customer loyalty, reflecting its focus on efficiency and value. Sam's Club falls in the middle, with moderate product variety and slightly lower loyalty, while BJ's is positioned with higher product variety but lower efficiency and weaker overall performance. This comparison shows that firms that prioritize efficiency and customer retention outperform those that focus on offering a wider range of products. Overall, Costco's ability to maintain both high efficiency and strong loyalty explains its leadership position within the industry.

Strategic Recommendation

In this report, we recommend that Costco Wholesale implement a regional rollout of electric vehicle (EV) charging stations across its warehouse locations, beginning in the Southeastern United States, with long-term plans for national expansion. This initiative should be carried out through a backward integration strategy, in which Costco develops, owns, and operates its own EV charging network rather than relying solely on third-party providers. Instead of outsourcing to companies such as ChargePoint or Tesla, Costco would internalize critical components of the EV charging value chain, including hardware procurement, pricing control, and potentially energy sourcing.

This strategy should begin with a phased deployment of DC fast chargers in the Southeastern market, followed by expansion into additional regions based on performance data and demand trends. The objective is to strengthen Costco's competitive advantage in cost

leadership and customer loyalty while positioning the company as a forward-thinking retailer in a rapidly evolving transportation and energy landscape.

Costco's core competitive advantage lies in its ability to deliver high-quality goods at the lowest possible prices, supported by its membership-based business model and operational efficiency. The EV charging initiative directly reinforces this advantage in several ways. First, EV charging aligns naturally with Costco's high-traffic warehouse model. Customers typically spend between 30- and 60-minutes shopping in-store, which closely matches the time required for DC fast charging. This alignment creates a seamless integration between Costco's retail operations and EV charging usage, increasing both convenience and utilization.

Second, the initiative strengthens Costco's membership value proposition. By offering discounted or exclusive charging rates to members, Costco can further differentiate its membership benefits and increase both customer acquisition and retention. This mirrors the success of Costco's gasoline strategy, where lower prices drive consistent traffic and reinforce loyalty. Third, EV adoption in the United States continues to grow rapidly, driven by advancements from companies like Tesla as well as government incentives and environmental policies. By investing early, Costco can secure a strong position in a developing market while competitors are still scaling their infrastructure.

This recommendation is also highly aligned with Costco's mission of providing exceptional value to its members. EV charging enhances the overall customer experience without deviating from Costco's commitment to affordability. At the same time, the initiative supports broader sustainability goals by contributing to reduced carbon emissions and promoting cleaner transportation options. By owning its EV charging infrastructure, Costco can ensure that cost savings are passed directly to members, reinforcing its value-driven identity. Additionally,

backward integration supports Costco's operational philosophy of efficiency and control, enabling the company to manage costs more effectively over time compared to reliance on third-party providers.

The implementation of this strategy should occur in three structured phases. During the first phase, Costco should establish a strong operational foundation by piloting company-owned EV chargers in high-demand markets within the Southeast, particularly in states such as Florida. In this stage, the company would focus on sourcing charging hardware directly from manufacturers, developing internal systems for monitoring and maintenance, and testing pricing strategies that align with its low-cost positioning. While limited technical partnerships may still be necessary, Costco should prioritize maintaining ownership and control over its infrastructure. The primary objective of this phase is to validate demand and gather performance data to guide future expansion.

In the second phase, Costco would expand its EV charging network to additional high-traffic locations across the Southeast while improving operational efficiency. This expansion would involve standardizing charger design and installation processes to reduce costs and ensure consistency across locations. Costco would also refine its pricing model using real-time usage data, potentially implementing dynamic pricing strategies to maximize utilization and profitability. Additionally, the company could begin integrating renewable energy solutions, such as solar panels, to reduce long-term electricity costs and improve sustainability.

In the final phase, Costco would complete a full regional rollout and fully integrate EV charging into its core business model. This would involve scaling infrastructure across the majority of Southeastern locations and leveraging economies of scale to reduce per-unit costs. At

this stage, EV charging would become a fully embedded component of Costco's operations, similar to its gasoline services, and a key driver of both customer traffic and membership value.

Backward integration significantly enhances Costco's profitability by allowing the company to retain full control over charging revenue rather than sharing profits with third-party providers. In addition to direct revenue from charging sessions, EV infrastructure supports increased membership growth and retention by offering unique, high-value benefits. Customers charging their vehicles are also likely to spend more time inside the warehouse, increasing overall transaction size and boosting in-store sales. Over time, ownership of the infrastructure enables Costco to reduce operating costs through economies of scale, improved supplier negotiations, and energy optimization strategies. This model closely resembles Costco's gasoline operations, where low prices drive traffic while still contributing meaningfully to overall profitability.

This recommendation effectively leverages Costco's key strengths, including its strong financial position, loyal membership base, and ability to operate high-volume, low-margin services efficiently. It also addresses existing weaknesses by introducing a new layer of service differentiation beyond pricing and reducing reliance on traditional retail transactions as the sole source of value creation. At the same time, the strategy captures significant opportunities associated with the rapid growth of the EV market and enables Costco to expand into a new, vertically integrated revenue stream. Additionally, it helps mitigate competitive threats from major retailers such as Sam's Club and BJ's Wholesale Club by creating a differentiated and difficult-to-replicate customer experience.

This strategy is highly feasible given Costco's strong financial performance, consistent cash flow, and extensive real estate footprint. The company already operates large parking facilities and has experience managing fuel stations, making the transition into EV charging a natural

extension of its existing operations. A phased implementation over a three- to five-year period within the Southeast allows Costco to manage risk, gather data, and scale efficiently without overcommitting resources.

Backward integration into EV charging ultimately strengthens Costco's competitive advantage by lowering long-term costs and increasing control over customer experience. It also creates barriers to entry for competitors, as replicating a fully integrated charging network requires significant capital investment and operational expertise. Furthermore, by embedding EV charging into its membership model, Costco increases switching costs and deepens customer loyalty. As a result, the company reinforces its value leadership strategy while expanding into a high-growth market.

By pursuing backward integration into EV charging infrastructure, Costco Wholesale can extend its cost leadership strategy into a new industry while remaining aligned with its core mission. This recommendation is both practical and forward-looking, offering new revenue opportunities, enhanced customer loyalty, and sustainable long-term competitive advantages. With careful execution and a phased regional rollout, Costco can position itself as a leader in both retail and EV infrastructure. A critical element of this strategy's long-term success is a membership-integrated pricing model that mirrors Costco's existing gas discount structure. Based on our financial model, the base charging rate would be set at \$0.37 per kWh, consistent with Wawa's established market rate, while members would receive a \$0.04 per kWh discount bringing their effective rate to \$0.33 per kWh. Non-members would pay the standard rate, creating a visible, quantifiable incentive to hold or upgrade a membership. This tiered structure accomplishes two objectives simultaneously: it generates direct revenue from charging sessions while converting the EV charger into a membership acquisition and retention tool. Executive

members, who already account for approximately 73.3% of worldwide net sales, represent the most likely early adopters, and the discount deepens the financial case for maintaining an Executive-tier membership. As EV ownership grows, this pricing architecture becomes an increasingly powerful differentiator that competitors without a membership model cannot easily replicate.

While the Southeast is the appropriate starting point, the long-term vision for this strategy extends well beyond the region. Following a successful Southeastern rollout, Costco should pursue national expansion targeting its highest-traffic markets. California, which accounts for 27% of U.S. net sales and leads the nation in EV ownership, represents the most compelling next market, followed by the Pacific Northwest, Texas, and the Mid-Atlantic corridor. A full national build-out would also allow Costco to negotiate more favorable hardware pricing through volume procurement, compressing per-unit capital costs below the \$49,500 private-label figure used in the current model and further strengthening the long-term potential of the investment.

Financial Justification of Strategy

Recommending that Costco invests in a private-label EV fast-charging network across its southeastern warehouses requires a realistic look at whether the project is financially feasible and worth the long-term commitment. As the EV market continues to grow, retailers with large parking lots and steady customer traffic are in a strong position to benefit from a large charging infrastructure. Since Costco is the leader in the wholesale warehouse industry, we needed to make sure our proposal undoubtedly shows feasible numbers and assumptions that fit the company's overall strategy. This section breaks down all assumptions, potential profitability, and economic logic behind our recommendation.

It is very important to recognize Costco's financial strength. Due to their dominance in the industry, they have created a budget of \$150 million for our recommendation. Costco plans to fund the project entirely with cash reserves, without having to bear any debt. Paying for this project upfront avoids interest costs and keeps their balance sheet clean. Since it is such a large investment, and Costco wants to guarantee profitability, the client has set the weighted average cost of capital, or hurdle rate, at 20%. Meaning the final metric of internal rate of return (IRR), needs to exceed the hurdle rate in our investment to be considered profitable. The start of the financial analysis is done by making realistic assumptions, which we will begin to jump into.

Since our recommendation involves EV superchargers, we decided to look at Wawa with their recent implementation of electric vehicle charging ports. First, we found an average estimate of EV chargers per Wawa location in the United States, which was around 9.5. This is to help find a total number of chargers we recommend Costco install for all locations in the southeast region, which was 81 stores. We then found a Costco to Wawa square footage multiplier, which was 40.8. Our final assumption of total chargers at all Costco's was found by multiplying all three numbers and taking 8% of that number given that 8% of cars sold in the US last year were EV's. That gives 2,510 chargers and 31 supercharger ports per location. After finding the total chargers, we must estimate the total cost of this investment and make sure it fits the \$150 million budget. We found the total cost for a DC fast charger was around \$34,500. We also believe it would be best for Costco to backwards integrate and private label their chargers, so they do not pay royalties to Tesla. We assumed a private label cost would be around 40% of the original cost, so the final cost per charger became \$49,500. The total initial investment will be \$124,222,581.

Through Tesla's 2025 quarterly reports, we were able to find an estimated first year revenue. This was found through finding the total throughput per stall annually, 91,615 kWh, multiplied by Wawa's charging rate of \$0.37, which showed an average revenue of just under \$34,000 per stall. However, since we are recommending the membership offer a discount, we assumed there would be a 4-cent discount on the 37-cent kWh rate, and the new revenue per stall would be \$30,438. When multiplied by the total number of chargers, we get a total revenue of \$76,386,015. Since Tesla supercharger sales have grown 18% year over year, we did a conservative estimate of a 13% growth rate, so the initial first year revenue will increase by 13% per year.

Now, we must take the revenue, and turn it into a final annual cash flow, and this is done by subtracting costs and taxes, and depreciation measures. There are two main costs, both variable costs, and those are electric costs and maintenance costs. We found the electric costs to be 46.7% of revenue, and this was found through Florida's average electricity rate, and the average throughput per stall. We found the maintenance costs to be around 2.63% of revenue, and this was found by finding an average figure for maintenance of EV fast chargers. We then assumed a variable cost growth rate of 8% year over year, including inflation and reinvestment of profits. Next, we calculated depreciation, which was the cost of the machines without the private label fee, subtracted by shipping, and this was \$81,560,280. Then that was divided by a useful life of 8 years, which we assumed to be a reasonable life for the EV chargers. Next, a tax rate of 21% was taken from the cash flow for each year, then depreciation added back.

The pro forma's main objective was to evaluate if this investment is worthwhile for Costco. The main measurements for that are net present value (NPV) and internal rate of return (IRR). Our research and financial analysis provided an NPV of \$45,503,766 and an IRR of 27.8%. For IRR,

we immediately can note that it is a worthy investment due to it being higher than the hurdle rate of 20%, meaning the expected return on the investment is expected to be 7.8% higher than Costco's already high WACC. Second, NPV is a positive, and high number, which indicates high profits, and resolidifies the integrity of the investment. Overall, Costco's investment of EV fast chargers into all southeast region locations would be extremely financially viable.

Fall-out

While installing EV charging stations across Costco locations presents a compelling opportunity to strengthen long-term competitive advantage, several risks and unintended consequences must be considered.

The first concern is operational strain and infrastructure limitations. Many Costco warehouses may require significant electrical upgrades to support fast charging, which could delay deployment and increase costs. Additionally, increased dwell time from EV users could lead to parking congestion, frustrating traditional customers. Costco can address this by placing chargers in designated areas of the lot, implementing charging time limits, and aligning charger placement with typical shopping duration.

There is also a competitive response risk. Rivals such as Walmart, Target, and Amazon via partnerships or physical hubs may accelerate their own EV infrastructure investments, reducing Costco's differentiation. However, Costco can maintain an edge by integrating EV charging into its membership model, offering discounted charging rates exclusively to members

like its gas pricing strategy thereby reinforcing customer loyalty rather than competing solely on infrastructure availability.

Finally, brand and customer experience risks must be considered. If chargers are frequently broken, occupied, or difficult to use, customer satisfaction could decline rather than improve. Costco should ensure high reliability standards, routine maintenance, and user-friendly interfaces, potentially outsourcing operations to experienced charging network providers.

References

- Compare Before Buying. (2024). *Sam's Club vs. Costco: Review and comparison*. Retrieved from <https://www.comparebeforebuying.com/sams-club-vs-costco/>
- Costco Wholesale Corporation. (2025). *Annual report 2024: Form 10-K*. U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission. Retrieved from <https://investor.costco.com>
- GlobalData. (2024). *Costco Wholesale Corp: Financial and strategic analysis review* (Reference Code: GDRT28577FSA). GlobalData Plc.
- GlobalData. (2026). *Costco Wholesale Corp: Company profile and strategic analysis*. GlobalData Plc. Retrieved April 13, 2026.
- MarketLine. (2026). *Costco Wholesale Corporation: Company profile* (Reference Code: 7EE0FB19-6C6E-4865-AFD1-D601275DC508). Progressive Digital Media.
- Pew Research Center. (2023, July 13). How Americans view electric vehicles. Retrieved from <https://www.pewresearch.org/short-reads/2023/07/13/how-americans-view-electric-vehicles/>

Tesla, Inc. (2025). *Quarterly financial reports*. Retrieved from <https://ir.tesla.com>

Financial Assumptions and Additional Sources

Delco Today. (2026, March). *Wawa is getting into the electric vehicle supercharger business*.

Retrieved from <https://delco.today/2026/03/electric-vehicle-superchargers-wawa/>

EVSHIFT. (n.d.). *What is the percentage of electric cars in the US?* Retrieved from

<https://www.evshift.com/352944/what-is-the-percentage-of-electric-cars-in-the-us/>

EV Charging Stations. (2025). *Tesla Supercharger usage in Q2 2025 reaches 1.6 TWh and 45*

million sessions. Retrieved from <https://evchargingstations.com/chargingnews/tesla-supercharger-usage-in-q2-2025-reaches-1-6-twh-and-45-million-sessions/>

Feyree. (n.d.). *EV charger durability and lifespan guide*. Retrieved from

<https://www.feyree.com/blogs/news/ev-charger-durability-lifespan>

LatestCost. (2026). *DC fast charger installation cost guide 2026*. Retrieved from

<https://latestcost.com/dc-fast-charger-installation-cost/>

McGinnis Investment Management. (2025). *Costco Wholesale's U.S. operations in 2025:*

Footprint and performance. Retrieved from <https://www.mmginvest.com/post/costco-wholesale-s-u-s-operations-in-2025-footprint-and-performance>

Recharged. (n.d.). *How much does a commercial EV charging station cost?* Retrieved from

<https://recharged.com/articles/how-much-does-a-commercial-ev-charging-station-cost>

Tesla, Inc. (2025). *Q3 2025 update*. Retrieved from <https://assets-ir.tesla.com/tesla-contents/IR/TSLA-Q3-2025-Update.pdf>

Wawa. (n.d.). *Major exits locations for fueling & EV charging*. Retrieved from <https://www.wawa.com/fuel-exits>

Wawa Inc. (2017). *Wawa Inc.* CSP Daily News. Retrieved from <https://www.cspdailynews.com/top-202-convenience-stores-2017/wawa-inc>

What Is the Costco Gas Discount. (n.d.). *What is the Costco gas discount: Unveiling member savings at the pump*. Costco Gas Price Tracker. Retrieved from <https://costcogaspricetracker.com/what-is-the-costco-gas-discount/>